

✦ THE FIELD GUIDE · 2026 EDITION

CHATGPT CODES

18 copy-ready prompt shortcuts to think sharper,
learn faster, write clearly, research carefully, and ship
stronger work.

FREE RESOURCE

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FIRST, THE HONEST BIT

They aren't secret commands. They're better instructions.

ChatGPT does not have a universal hidden slash-command language. These “codes” are memorable prompt starters you can paste into a chat and customize. Better input does not guarantee a perfect answer, but it makes useful output far more likely.

The six-part prompt formula

You rarely need all six parts. Add the ones that remove meaningful ambiguity.

01	02	03
Role	Goal	Context
04	05	06
Constraints	Format	Quality check



Role Act as a product strategist. **Goal** Create a launch plan for my budgeting app. **Context** It helps freelancers manage irregular income. **Constraints** Two-person team, four weeks, \$2,000 budget. **Format** Weekly table with owner and metric. **Quality check** Flag assumptions and the three biggest risks.

18 codes for real work

Replace anything in [BRACKETS], add your material, and keep the parts you need.

01

THINK

/clarify

Find the real brief

When your idea is still fuzzy.

```
Before answering, ask me the 3 highest-impact questions needed to understand my goal, audience, constraints, and definition of success. Then restate the brief in one paragraph.
```

02

THINK

/angles

Open up the options

When the first idea feels too obvious.

```
Generate 10 meaningfully different approaches to [GOAL]. Group them as safe, bold, and unconventional. For each, give the core idea, likely upside, and biggest risk. Avoid cosmetic variations.
```

/decide

Make a reasoned choice

When several options look good.

Compare [OPTIONS] for [GOAL]. First propose 5 weighted criteria, explain the weights, score each option from 1–10, run a sensitivity check, and recommend one. State what new fact could change the decision.

/teach

Build a mental model

When you want understanding, not trivia.

Teach me [TOPIC] at a [BEGINNER/INTERMEDIATE/ADVANCED] level. Start with an intuitive mental model, then the mechanics, one worked example, common misconceptions, and a 5-question self-test with answers hidden below a divider.

/socratic

Learn by being guided

When active recall matters.

Coach me through [TOPIC] using the Socratic method. Ask one question at a time, adapt to my answer, give a small hint before revealing anything, and finish with a concise summary of the gaps I should review.

/analogy

Make complexity click

When the explanation is too abstract.

Explain [CONCEPT] through 3 analogies: everyday life, business, and a technical system. Map each part of the analogy to the real concept, then clearly identify where each analogy breaks down.

/draft

Create a strong first version

When the blank page is the problem.

Draft a [FORMAT] about [TOPIC] for [AUDIENCE]. Goal: [OUTCOME]. Voice: [VOICE]. Include [MUST-HAVES], avoid [EXCLUSIONS], and keep it to [LENGTH]. Lead with the strongest point, not background.

/rewrite

Improve without losing meaning

When the content is right but the delivery is not.

Rewrite the text below for clarity, energy, and natural rhythm while preserving every material claim. Remove repetition and jargon. Match this voice: [VOICE]. Return the rewrite first, followed by 3 notable edits. TEXT: [PASTE].

/repurpose

Turn one idea into a system

When one source should power many channels.

Repurpose [SOURCE] into: a 5-post social thread, a 150-word newsletter, a 30-second video script, and 5 headline options. Adapt the hook and pacing to each format; do not merely shorten the same copy.

/research

Create an evidence plan

When you need current, sourced information.

Research [QUESTION] using current reliable sources if browsing is available. Separate established facts, expert interpretation, and uncertainty. Cite each time-sensitive claim with a direct link and publication date. If browsing is unavailable, say so before answering.

/compare

See trade-offs clearly

When a feature list is not enough.

Compare [A] and [B] for [USE CASE] in a table covering cost, setup, capability, limitations, privacy, and best-fit user. Follow with the 3 trade-offs that matter most and a recommendation by user type.

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RESEARCH

/verify

Pressure-test the answer

When accuracy matters more than speed.

Audit the following answer claim by claim. Label each as supported, uncertain, outdated, or incorrect. Explain why, provide a corrected version, and list the sources or primary evidence needed to verify any unresolved claim. ANSWER: [PASTE].

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BUILD

/plan

Turn a goal into action

When you know the outcome but not the path.

Create an execution plan for [GOAL] given [CONTEXT/CONSTRAINTS]. Break it into milestones, concrete tasks, dependencies, owner, effort, and success metric. Identify the critical path and the smallest useful first step I can do today.

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BUILD

/prototype

Design the smallest test

When you need evidence before commitment.

Design a low-cost prototype to test this assumption: [ASSUMPTION]. Define the target user, test artifact, procedure, pass/fail metric, sample size, timebox, and what we will do for each possible result.

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BUILD

/code

Specify before coding

When you want usable implementation, not a snippet dump.

```
Act as a senior [STACK] engineer. Build [FEATURE] within these constraints:
[CONSTRAINTS]. First list assumptions and file changes. Then provide production-
ready code, edge cases, accessibility/security considerations, and focused tests.
Do not invent unavailable APIs.
```

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REFINE

/critique

Get useful, specific feedback

When 'make it better' is too vague.

```
Critique this [WORK] against [GOAL] for [AUDIENCE]. Evaluate clarity, accuracy,
structure, persuasion, and distinctiveness. Rank issues by impact, quote the exact
weak point, and propose a concrete fix for each. WORK: [PASTE].
```

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REFINE

/redteam

Expose hidden weaknesses

Before a launch or high-stakes decision.

```
Red-team this plan from the perspectives of a skeptical customer, competitor,
operator, and risk reviewer. Find fragile assumptions, failure modes, abuse cases,
and second-order effects. Rank by likelihood × impact and propose mitigations.
```

/polish

Run the final quality pass

When the work is almost ready to ship.

```
Perform a final quality pass on [WORK]. Check factual consistency, logic, completeness, tone, formatting, accessibility, and obvious edge cases. Fix safe issues directly, flag changes that require my judgment, and return a short pre-publish checklist.
```

Stack codes into a workflow

The biggest gains come from iteration. Treat the first answer as material, not the finish line.

1	<code>/clarify</code>	Turn the idea into a usable brief.
2	<code>/angles</code>	Explore options before committing.
3	<code>/draft</code>	Create the first complete version.
4	<code>/critique</code>	Find the highest-impact gaps.
5	<code>/polish</code>	Make it ready to publish.



Give it a finish line

Define the audience, desired action, format, and what "good" means.



Bring source material

Examples, notes, data, and reference text beat vague requests every time.



Ask for alternatives

Request contrasting options, then choose and refine instead of accepting draft one.



Verify what matters

Check important facts, calculations, citations, and decisions against primary sources.

USE AI WITH JUDGMENT

A quick pre-send checklist

- ✓ Remove private, confidential, or regulated information.
- ✓ Say when current web research and citations are required.
- ✓ Verify high-stakes medical, legal, financial, and safety advice with a qualified professional.
- ✓ Review the final work in your own voice before publishing or sending it.

KEEP THIS ON YOUR DESK

**Good prompts don't replace
thinking.
They give it leverage.**



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